

Hands-on Lab: Review Security Threat Reports using X-Force Threat Exchange

Estimated time needed: 15 minutes

X-Force Threat Exchange is a cloud-based, collaborative platform developed by IBM. Its primary function is facilitating user sharing of security-related information and threat intelligence. With X-Force, you have access to real-time feeds of threat intelligence shared by other users. You can also contribute data about potential threats, vulnerabilities, and risky IP addresses. The ability to exchange information allows everyone to enhance their cybersecurity measures, stay up-to-date about the latest threats, and take proactive steps to protect the systems and networks.

Objectives

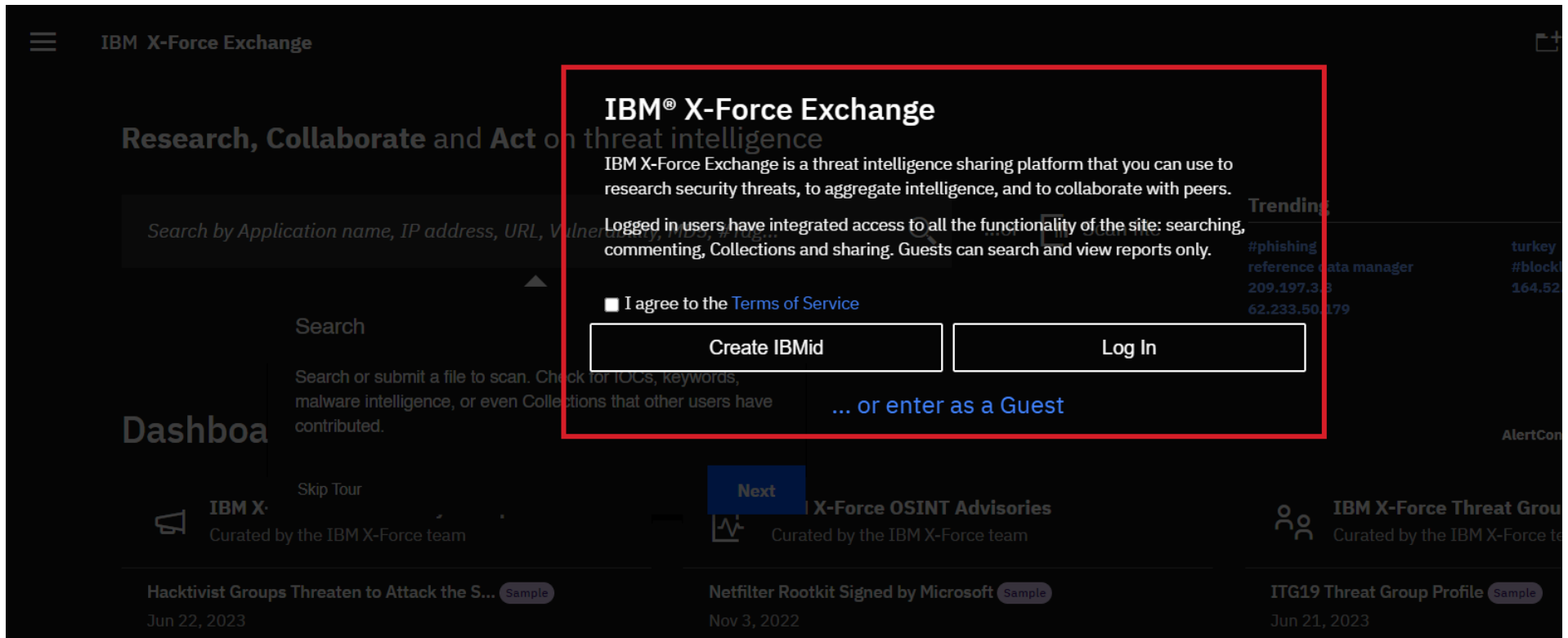
After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Navigate the X-force Exchange Dashboard
- Review available reports and information

Exercise 1: Get started with X-Force Exchange Dashboard

In this exercise, you will launch the X-Force Exchange website and take a tour of the Dashboard.

1. Launch the IBM X-Force Exchange website by using the URL, <https://exchange.xforce.ibmcloud.com/>.
2. The first time that you log in to the site, you will be prompted to either create an IBM ID, login with valid credentials, or enter as a guest.



3. For this demo:

1. Select the **Terms of Service** checkbox.
2. Click **enter as Guest**.

4. The X-Force Exchange Dashboard is displayed. The first time when you enter the X-Force Exchange Dashboard, a tour of the Dashboard will automatically launch. You can either click **Next** to continue with the tour or click **Skip tour** to display the X-Force Exchange Dashboard.

The screenshot shows the IBM X-Force Exchange Dashboard. At the top, there's a navigation bar with the IBM X-Force Exchange logo and a hamburger menu icon. Below the navigation bar, the main heading reads "Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence". A search bar is prominently displayed with the placeholder text "Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...". To the right of the search bar, there's a "Scan file" button. Below the search bar, a tour overlay is visible, featuring a "Search" title, a description of the search functionality, and two buttons: "Skip Tour" and "Next". The "Next" button is highlighted with a red border. The dashboard is divided into several sections: "IBM X-Force OSINT Advisories" (curated by the IBM X-Force team), "IBM X-Force Threat Group" (curated by the IBM X-Force team), "IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports" (curated by the IBM X-Force team), and "IBM X-Force Industry Reports" (curated by the IBM X-Force team). Each section contains a list of items with titles, dates, and "Sample" or "Updated" labels. For example, under "OSINT Advisories", there are items like "Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S...", "Update: Hacktivists Continue Targeting...", "PWNLNK Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T...", and "Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On...". Under "Threat Group", there are items like "ITG19 Threat Group Profile", "ITG12 Threat Group Profile", "Hive0103 Threat Group Profile", and "ITG01 Threat Group Profile".

5. Familiarize yourself with the layout and functionalities by taking the tour.

6. The Dashboard provides a high-level overview of all the shared threat intelligence.


IBM X-Force Exchange


Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence


 ...or  Scan file

Trending

#phishing
reference data manager
164.52.0.93
62.233.50.179

turkey
#blocklis
209.197.

Dashboard





IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S...
Sample

Jun 22, 2023

Update: Hacktivists Continue Targeting...

Oct 26, 2023 

PWNLNX Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T...

Oct 18, 2023 

Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On...

Oct 12, 2023 

View more



IBM X-Force OSINT Advisories

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Netfilter Rootkit Signed by Microsoft
Sample

Nov 3, 2022

New Undetected Python-Based Info-Stealer Offer...

Oct 27, 2023  Updated

FakeUpdateRU Chrome Update Infection Spreads T...

Oct 27, 2023  Updated

Donation Fraud: Scammers Exploit Generosity in...

Oct 27, 2023  Updated

View more



IBM X-Force Threat Group

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

ITG19 Threat Group Profile
Sample

Jun 21, 2023

ITG12 Threat Group Profile

Sep 8, 2023 

Hive0103 Threat Group Profile

Aug 25, 2023 

ITG01 Threat Group Profile

Aug 19, 2023 



IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

HermeticWiper Analysis Report (IRIS-12790)
Sample

Feb 25, 2023



IBM X-Force Industry Reports

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Transportation Industry Profile
Sample

Jul 10, 2023



IBM X-Force Early Warning

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Vodafone Squatting Campaign

1. What are your observations from the Dashboard?
- Click here for some key observations about the Dashboard.

Note: You can unlock reports on the Dashboard if you have an account. You can create the account via the **Create IBMId** link at the top-right corner of the Dashboard.

Exercise 2: Review X-Force reports and other information

In this exercise, you will explore reports and information available in the different sections.

Task 1: Review X-Force Threat Analysis Reports

1. **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** is the first report section on the Dashboard and provides a list of the most recent threats compiled by the IBM X-Force team.

IBM X-Force Exchange

Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence

Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...  ...or  Scan file

Trending

- #phishing reference data manager 164.52.0.93 62.233.50.179
- turkey #blocklis 209.197.

Dashboard

IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S... [Sample](#)
Jun 22, 2023
- Update: Hacktivists Continue Targeting...
Oct 26, 2023 
- PWNLNX Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T...
Oct 18, 2023 
- Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On...
Oct 12, 2023 

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IBM X-Force OSINT Advisories
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- Netfilter Rootkit Signed by Microsoft [Sample](#)
Nov 3, 2022
- New Undetected Python-Based Info-Stealer Offer...
Oct 27, 2023  [Updated](#)
- FakeUpdateRU Chrome Update Infection Spreads T...
Oct 27, 2023  [Updated](#)
- Donation Fraud: Scammers Exploit Generosity in...
Oct 27, 2023  [Updated](#)

[View more](#)

IBM X-Force Threat Group Profiles
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- ITG19 Threat Group Profile [Sample](#)
Jun 21, 2023
- ITG12 Threat Group Profile
Sep 8, 2023 
- Hive0103 Threat Group Profile
Aug 25, 2023 
- ITG01 Threat Group Profile
Aug 19, 2023 

IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- HermeticWiper Analysis Report (IRIS-12790) [Sample](#)
Feb 25, 2023

IBM X-Force Industry Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- Transportation Industry Profile [Sample](#)
Jul 10, 2023

IBM X-Force Early Warnings
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

- Vodafone Squatting Campaign

The **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** section provides comprehensive documents that detail specific cybersecurity threats. Each piece typically includes a brief overview of the threat, its origin or source, and the nature of its potential impact on your system. It also highlights the vulnerabilities that the threat may exploit. This aids you in understanding any specific weakness in your system that can potentially be compromised.

The reports also provide information about the IP addresses of the threat targets. This helps users identify if their networks or certain parts of their networks have been, or could be, targeted. These analysis reports often include mitigation strategies or recommendations for protecting your systems against the identified threat. This equips users with practical, actionable steps to enhance their cybersecurity measures.

2. Hover over a report name for a brief overview of the report.
3. Click a report to view the details. For this exercise, click the **Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the SWIFT Network** report.
4. A detailed view of the report will be displayed. You will find details, such as the threat's source, reported vulnerabilities, and the affected IP addresses.
5. Optionally, you can explore other reports in the **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** section.

Task 2: Review the Early Warning Data section

1. Scroll down to the Early Warning Data section.

The screenshot displays the IBM X-Force Exchange dashboard. The top navigation bar includes the IBM X-Force Exchange logo and a hamburger menu icon. The main content area is divided into several sections. The **Early Warning Data** section, located in the top-left, is highlighted with a red border. It features a list of domain names: **zosjkfg.store**, **zamgnytw.shop**, **yoyuiwhjhe.shop**, and **ylrdhcqsgu.shop**, each with a "Registered: 2 hours ago" status. To the right of this section is the **Coronavirus Attack Source Distribution** section, which includes a world map and statistics: "Affected Countries/Regions: 71", "Peak: Apr 10, 2020", and "Trend" with an upward arrow. Further right is the **Malicious Activity** section, showing a list of activity types: Total, Command and Control, Spam, Malware, and Scanning. Below the Early Warning Data section is the **Vulnerabilities** section, featuring a list of vulnerabilities: **Apache ActiveMQ and ActiveMQ Legacy OpenWire Module code execution**, with a consequence of "Gain Access". To the right of the Vulnerabilities section is the **Public Collections** section, which includes a "Recommended" list. The bottom right corner of the dashboard shows the **Groups** section, which is partially visible.

This section provides users with critical, forward-looking information about emerging threats and potential vulnerabilities. The data in this section is new and includes information added within the few hours and is designed to provide you with a head start in identifying, understanding, and mitigating unknown risks before they become widespread issues. Examples of early warning data include newly discovered malware, suspicious IP activity, unusual network patterns, and other potential signs of compromise.

2. Hover the mouse over an early warning for additional information.
3. Click an early warning for more details.

Task 3: Review the Malicious Activity section

1. The **Malicious Activity** section provides a real-time map-based feed of security events flagged as potentially malicious within the last hour. It offers critical insights into the latest threat landscape, including details about the types of attacks, their sources, targeted regions, and the affected IP addresses. Each event in this section is linked to a more detailed report, offering users a deeper understanding of the threat, its potential impact, and recommended mitigation strategies.

The screenshot displays the IBM X-Force Exchange dashboard with a dark theme. The top navigation bar includes a hamburger menu icon, the text 'IBM X-Force Exchange', and a plus icon. The dashboard is organized into a grid of sections:

- Early Warning Data:** Features a network diagram icon and the text 'Stay ahead of threats with Early Warning data'. Below this, a list of domains is shown, each with a red vertical bar and the text 'Registered: 2 hours ago':
 - zosjkfg.store
 - zamgnytw.shop
 - yoyiuiwhjhe.shop
 - ylrdhcqsgu.shop
- Coronavirus Attack Source Distribution:** Includes a network diagram icon, the title 'Coronavirus Attack Source Distribution', and the subtitle 'Attack map related to COVID-19'. It features a world map with red highlights indicating affected areas. Below the map, the following statistics are displayed:

Metric	Value
Affected Countries/Regions	71
Peak	Apr 10, 2020
Trend	↗
- Malicious Activity:** This section is highlighted with a red border. It features a pulse line icon, the title 'Malicious Activity', and the subtitle 'Malicious activity in the last hour'. Below this, a list of activity types is shown:
 - Total
 - Command and Control
 - Spam
 - Malware
 - Scanning
- Vulnerabilities:** Includes a bug icon, the title 'Vulnerabilities', and the subtitle 'The latest global security risks'. Below this, a list of vulnerabilities is shown, each with a red vertical bar and the text 'Consequences: Gain Access':
 - Apache ActiveMQ and ActiveMQ Legacy OpenWire Module code execution
- Public Collections:** Features a folder icon, the title 'Public Collections', and the subtitle 'Publicly shared community findings'. Below this, the text 'Recommended' is displayed.
- Groups:** Includes a group of people icon, the title 'Groups', and the subtitle 'Focal point for collaboration and...'. Below this, a network diagram icon is shown.

2. Click the **Spam** data.
3. You will be able to view a complete report all IP addresses recently categorized for spam.

IBM X-Force Exchange ALL ▼ Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...					
Recently categorized IP addresses for Spam					
IP	123.188.39.156	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:20:31 AM	
IP	137.74.68.33	Spam	France	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:20:29 AM	
IP	42.57.190.120	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:20:27 AM	
IP	143.198.38.254	Spam	United States	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:20:00 AM	
IP	186.141.202.227	Spam, Bots	Argentina	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:18:25 AM	
IP	191.101.31.66	Spam	United States	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:18:23 AM	
IP	41.251.227.138	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	Morocco	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:18:21 AM	
IP	105.158.108.107	Spam, Bots	Morocco	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:18:19 AM	
IP	196.65.72.9	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	Morocco	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:18:18 AM	
IP	5.31.207.107	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	United Arab Emirates	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:17:25 AM	
IP	113.226.103.68	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China	Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:17:23 AM	
IP	117.50.60.213	Spam		Reported on Oct 29, 2023 5:17:21 AM	

This brings us to the end of the lab.

Congratulations! You have successfully completed this lab on X-Force Threat Exchange.

Author(s)